

The New Talent Acquisition *Operating Model*

The methodology behind a new hiring process



Attract · Engage · Convert

02 · THE 2-MINUTE READ

The methodology in *two minutes*

This methodology sets out a business-led talent acquisition operating model: how organisations move from requisition-led hiring to a standing, evergreen talent ecosystem. WeiTA calls this approach Attract, Engage and Convert.

WHAT WE OBSERVED

The search starts after the plan

Talent acquisition begins when a need is approved. The professionals the business needs most are passive, and the signals reaching leaders are shaped by AI on both sides.

WHAT IT COSTS

59%

of GCC leaders in India say talent gaps are holding back their plans.

PwC India-FICCI, August 2026

WHAT CHANGES

The model starts before the requisition

It attracts the right professionals into the organisation's own ecosystem, engages them on a steady cadence, and converts relationships into decisions.

Who you can reach



who knows you



who joins you

TAKEAWAY

Hiring that starts with a requisition reacts to the plan. Hiring that runs as a standing ecosystem is ready for it.

03 · CONTENTS

How to read *this*

The 2-minute read gives you the model. The pages marked **SLOW READ** are where it lives: give them the attention you would give a board paper, and the rest of the methodology will read itself.

WHY

04 Field notes	SLOW READ	2 min
05 Failure points 1–4		1 min
06 Failure points 5–7		1 min
07 If you lead the business		1 min

HOW THE MODEL WORKS

08 The operating model		1 min
09 Attract	SLOW READ	2 min
10 Engage	SLOW READ	2 min
11 Convert	SLOW READ	2 min
12 The Talent Connect room	SLOW READ	2 min
13 Conversion strategy and results		1 min
14 One need, start to finish	SLOW READ	2 min
15 Who does what		1 min
16 What changes, what stays	SLOW READ	2 min
17 Six avatars		1 min
18 TA leaders at the forefront	SLOW READ	2 min
19 Measures beyond time-to-fill		1 min

WHERE TO BEGIN

20 Self-assessment		2 min
21 One capability, one quarter	SLOW READ	2 min

CLOSE

22 WeiTA in three sentences · Glossary · Sources		2 min
--	--	-------

READER PATHS

If you lead the business

CEO · COO · CFO · founder · GCC head

Pages 2, 5–7, 8, 12–13, 17, 21 **10 min**

If you lead people

CHRO

Pages 2, 4–8, 13, 15–19 **15 min**

If you lead talent acquisition

Every page; begin with the self-assessment on 20

Pages 20, then 4–22 **30 min**

If you recruit

Recruiter · TA Team Lead

Pages 2, 8–12, 16–17 **10 min**

If you manage a team that is hiring

Hiring manager

Pages 2, 6, 12, 14, 17 **6 min**

04 · FIELD NOTES

What we heard in the *market*

Before proposing a model, we listened. Through 2025 and 2026, WeiTA has spent its time in rooms with talent leaders, CHROs and hiring managers: client conversations, summit floors and working sessions. The notes below are anonymised.

The specialists are not in the funnel

A technology talent team at a global healthcare GCC told us volume hiring was handled. Their gap was a different market altogether: top-tier specialists in AI, product and health technology who were not engaging at all. What they wanted was a community that is always on, long before roles open.

The freeze problem

When global shifts freeze roles, talent acquisition is still expected to hold cost down, keep the team usefully occupied, and stop what it has built from fading while nothing is open.

A pop-up, not a home

Events, campus drives and walk-ins work like pop-up stores: busy for a day, gone the next. They gather people for the role open that week and pour them back into the same pipeline. What leaders asked for was a place that stays open, where the conversation carries on between roles.

AI is talking to AI

At a talent technology summit in Bengaluru, CHROs described the same pattern: the process is inflated by AI on one side, and résumés and interview answers are inflated by AI on the other. Each side reads an enhanced version of the other.

The relay

A business need travels from task to responsibility, to role, to job description, to recruiters and partners sourcing from the same visible pool, and back. The leader receives what was conveyed, not what was engaged.

The shift they asked for

Leaders compared today's process to putting up scaffolding for every role: post, attract, engage, hire, then take it down and build again for the next. They want a permanent structure instead, with Attract, Engage and Convert running continuously, and to be the employer of choice before a role opens.

"Community is not something you build and then shelve."

Technology TA leader, global healthcare GCC, 2026

TAKEAWAY

The people closest to hiring already see the problem. What they lack is not effort or tools; it is an operating model built for how the market now behaves.

05 • FAILURE POINTS

Where the old model *breaks*

The traditional model was built for a market where good people applied, signals were honest, and the business could wait. That market has changed. The model has stayed the same.

01

Talent acquisition starts when the need does

Hiring begins at the requisition, long after the business plan is set.

BUSINESS COST

Execution waits for the search, every time.

02

Critical roles wait, and growth waits with them

The roles a business can least afford to leave open stay open longest, while teams carry the load.

BUSINESS COST

Slipped launches, delayed revenue, rising vendor spend.

59%

of GCCs report delayed launches, projects or go-to-market plans · PwC India-FICCI, 2026

03

The organisation is invisible to the people it needs most

The best professionals are passive. Employer branding spends to be seen, and is rarely experienced.

BUSINESS COST

Competing for the visible few.

18%

of US organisations investing in employer branding can show its return · The Conference Board, 2025

04

Volume up, signal down: the AI doom loop

Applicants use AI; organisations use AI to screen them. Decisions rest on inflated signals.

BUSINESS COST

More interview time, less certainty.

45%

of assessments in India flagged for integrity concerns, FY26 · HirePro

TAKEAWAY

The model reacts to a need instead of preparing for it, and reads signals instead of people.

06 · FAILURE POINTS

Handoffs, gaps and a *narrow mandate*

05

The requisition relay

A business need passes through task, role, job description, recruiters and partners before it returns as a shortlist. Meaning is lost at each handoff, and the leader meets an interpretation, last.

BUSINESS COST

Leader time spent correcting the brief, and a higher risk of the wrong person in a role that matters.

06

Serial evaluation and funnel decay

One person at a time, round after round. Interest fades in the gaps between stages, and again between offer and joining.

BUSINESS COST

Panel hours consumed, offers abandoned, searches restarted.

07

Talent acquisition kept operational

Measured on budgets, time-to-fill and volume, the function stays away from the table where workforce plans are made.

BUSINESS COST

The business loses its strategic advisor on talent, just as capability becomes the constraint on growth.

“

Dropouts, in most cases, are not due to irrational decision-making. They are the result of comparative conviction-building. The candidate is simply more convinced elsewhere.

Devashish Sharma, Founding Member & CEO, Taggd, writing in People Matters, September 2025

TAKEAWAY

Funnel decay, translation loss and an operational mandate share one cause: hiring run as a relay of transactions instead of a continuous relationship.

07 · IF YOU LEAD THE BUSINESS

If you own *the plan*

Hiring now sits inside the business plan. A model that starts only when the need is approved will always leave the business waiting.

IF YOU RUN A GCC

Your mandate is growing from delivery to ownership, and talent readiness is now part of the case for your centre.

11% of GCC leaders say headquarters are weighing other geographies · PwC India-FICCI, 2026

IF YOU ARE THE CEO OR FOUNDER

Your plan moves in quarters. A search for a critical role can outlast one.

2,117 GCCs in India, employing 2.36 million people · Zinnov-nasscom, FY2026

IF YOU ARE THE COO

You feel talent gaps as delivery risk: projects re-sequenced, teams stretched, commitments renegotiated.

IF YOU ARE THE CFO

Talent spend arrives as separate costs, each justified alone, none building an asset the organisation keeps.

56% of GCCs report higher external vendor costs · PwC India-FICCI, 2026

IF YOU LEAD ANY FUNCTION THAT IS HIRING

Your best people spend hours in interview rounds, and still decide on a few conversations and a résumé.

“

Talent shortages persist because the challenge is not compensation alone; it is capability.

Dr C. Jayakumar, EVP & Head – Corporate HR, Larsen & Toubro · People Matters, August 2026

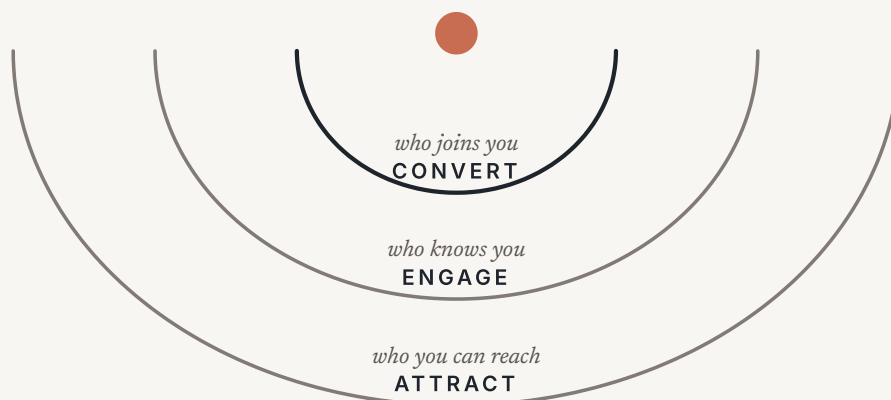
TAKEAWAY

If talent decides whether the plan happens, then talent acquisition belongs inside the plan, before the requisition.

08 · THE OPERATING MODEL

From requisitions to a *standing ecosystem*

A living community of the professionals an organisation will need, built before roles open and kept warm between them, and run in three stages.



STANDING, EVERGREEN TALENT ECOSYSTEM

STAGE 01

Attract

Map where the capability sits and bring the right professionals in, through curated entry.

Quality · Accessibility

Starts with the plan

The work begins before the need is approved.

STAGE 02

Engage

A steady calendar of research, publications and direct leader access.

Cadence · Visibility

Runs continuously

Each format has a job, each result a next step.

STAGE 03

Convert

Every engagement maps to a result. The Talent Connect room is where it shows most.

Hire · Branding · Intelligence

Re-architected around the business

The people stay at the centre.

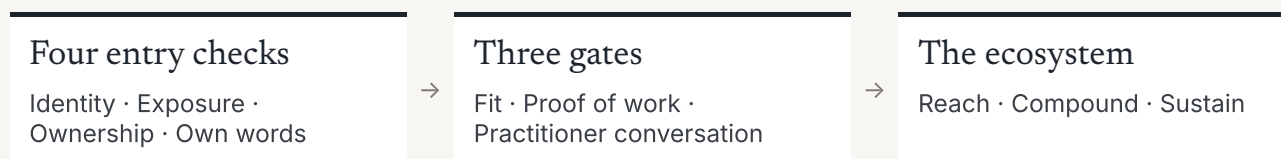
TAKEAWAY

Attract builds the reach, Engage the relationship, Convert the decision. The ecosystem stays with the organisation.

09 · ATTRACT · CURATED ENTRY AND ECOSYSTEM GROWTH

Who should we *know*?

Attract begins with the business, not with a job description. What will the plan need over the next year? Which capabilities are hardest to find? Where do the people with that capability actually work, write, build and gather? Only then does the organisation start inviting people in.



Curated entry. Entry into the ecosystem is checked before anything else, because the value of a community depends on who is in it. Four things are looked at first: identity (the person is who they say they are); project exposure (the work they have been part of); ownership (what they led, as distinct from what they sat near); and the person in their own words — through audio, video or their own writing, never a résumé alone.

Three gates. Entry then passes three gates: fit and context, proof of work specific to the capability, and a live conversation with a practitioner in the same domain. This is how the ecosystem stays credible to the professionals inside it and to the leaders who will one day make decisions from it.

Growth in three phases.

- *Reach* — direct sourcing, content and outreach to the professionals mapped in the market.
- *Compound* — referrals, peer nominations, adjacent communities and partners; good people bring good people.
- *Sustain* — recognition and an advocacy tier, so the most engaged members carry the organisation's story for it.

Attract is where the passive market finally becomes reachable. Professionals who would never apply will often accept an invitation to something useful: a conversation with practitioners, a look at real work, a place among peers. That invitation is the organisation's first chance to be experienced rather than advertised.

FIELD NOTE

A desk review of specialist employers found programmes and centres in place, but no standing relationship with the specialist market between openings; everything activated at entry level or when a role opened.

WeiTA desk review, September 2026

TAKEAWAY

Attract replaces “who applied?” with “who should we know?”, and answers it before the business needs to ask.

10 · ENGAGE · THE ENGAGEMENT CADENCE

Present, *never loud*

An ecosystem that is not engaged is just a database. Engage is the discipline that keeps relationships live: a steady cadence that gives professionals something of value each time, and asks very little of them.

WEEK 1 Leadership	WEEK 2 Capability	WEEK 3 Innovation	WEEK 4 Community & career
----------------------	----------------------	----------------------	------------------------------

ONE MONTHLY FLAGSHIP · TWO TRACKS: EARLY CAREER AND EXPERIENCED

Eight formats, eight jobs.

1. Publications and field notes — what the organisation is learning and building.
2. Leadership access — short videos, open question sessions with leaders.
3. External research content — the wider picture of the domain.
4. Organisation briefings — what the organisation is working on and why it matters.
5. Skill-building — expert sessions, deep dives and group projects.
6. Recognition — spotlights chosen by peers.
7. Peer and referral programmes — speed mentoring and roundtables.
8. One monthly flagship — a Build Day, hackathon or case challenge on a real problem.

A weekly rhythm. Leadership → Capability → Innovation → Community and career. Each week has a theme, so engagement never feels random and never piles up.

Two tracks. *Early career:* learn, build, prove. *Experienced:* access, contribute, lead. A senior architect and a graduate engineer want different things from the same organisation; the cadence respects that.

Led by practitioners. The formats are led by the people who do the work — engineers, product leaders, scientists, operators — with the TA team designing and running the calendar around them. Professionals want to meet the work, and the work is best explained by the people doing it.

Never daily. The cadence is designed to keep the organisation present, not loud. A minute at a time is enough to stay close.

This is also where funnel decay is answered. When a role opens, the people closest to it are already in an ongoing conversation with the organisation, so there is no cold gap to fall into.

FIELD NOTE

A GCC talent team told us they already know hackathons, events and games; what they look for is execution quality in the content and the engagement design.

Client conversation, September 2026

TAKEAWAY

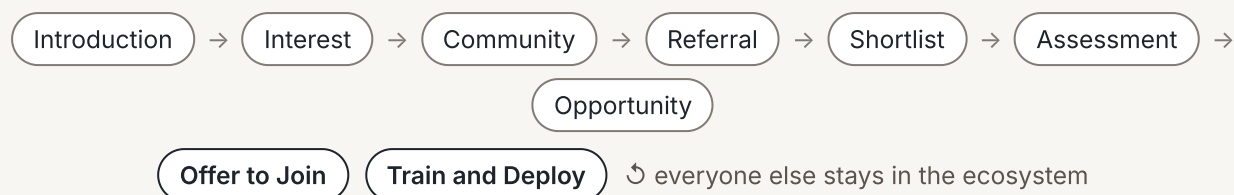
Engage turns an employer brand that is advertised into one that is experienced, week after week, by the people the organisation will need.

11 · CONVERT · THE CONVERSION ARCHITECTURE

Every engagement maps to a *result*

Engagement without conversion is activity. Convert is the architecture that turns relationships into decisions, deliberately and without pressure.

Each step moves a relationship forward, ending in **Offer to Join** for experienced professionals or **Train and Deploy** for early career.



Not everyone moves at the same pace, and not everyone should move at all. A professional can stay in the community for a year, contribute to a Build Day, refer two colleagues and never take a role, and still be valuable to the organisation. Conversion is not only about hiring; it is about every relationship producing something the business can use.

Why this is different from a pipeline. A pipeline is built for one role and emptied when the role closes. A conversion architecture is built for the ecosystem and keeps everyone inside it afterwards. People who were not chosen this time remain known, engaged and warmer for the next role. Each role makes the next one faster.

What the business sees. Leaders see professionals across the whole path: how they think in a deep dive, how they work in a group project, how peers regard them. By the time an opportunity is offered, the decision rests on a relationship and on real work, not on a résumé and a few rounds of interviews.

Where Convert becomes visible. Most of Convert runs quietly within the cadence. Its most visible moment is the Talent Connect room, the decision forum inside Convert, where professionals and the organisation's leaders meet around a real problem. It is described on the next page.

FIELD NOTE

Talent leaders told us a gathering earns their trust only when it carries a clear conversion strategy and the relationship continues after the day.

Conversations with TA leaders, 2026

TAKEAWAY

In this model nobody is “rejected” out of the ecosystem. Everyone either converts, contributes, or stays warmer for what comes next.

12 · THE TALENT CONNECT ROOM

One room, one day, *real work*

The Talent Connect room is part of the engagement activity, inside Convert. It exists for one reason: to create an immediate result for the organisation while the standing, evergreen ecosystem builds over time.

Who is in the room. Curated professionals, invited for one day, and the people who actually decide: talent acquisition leaders, hiring decision-makers and business leaders. No relay, no interpretation in between.



What makes it different. The room works on real problems from the business. Nothing is duplicated from other rounds. There are no AI-generated answers to read, because the work happens live, in conversation with peers and leaders. Nothing about it is transactional; it is a day of serious work that professionals value whether or not they take a role.

The flow of the day.

1. **Industry and business context** — where the organisation is going and why the capability matters.
2. **A skill-building session** — practitioners share how the work is actually done.
3. **Working groups on a live problem** — professionals build, rebuild and innovate on the organisation's real work, in place of the traditional group discussion.
4. **One-to-one leadership conversations** — direct, candid, both ways.
5. **Lunch and candid networking** — the culture, seen rather than described.
6. **The decision forum** — leaders and the TA team decide together, while what they saw is fresh.
7. **A short bridge to close decisions** — so that decisions made in the room become offers without falling into a gap.

In one day, a leader sees how a professional thinks, collaborates, handles ambiguity and responds to their own team — the things serial interviews try to infer and rarely see. And every professional leaves having experienced the organisation directly, which is what an employer brand is meant to be.

FIELD NOTE

The CHROs' test for any easier process: keep it only if it adds value to the business.

Talent technology summit, Bengaluru, 2026

TAKEAWAY

The Talent Connect room replaces a sequence of separate judgements with one shared day of real work, and a decision made by the people who will live with it.

13 · CONVERSION STRATEGY AND RESULTS

What the room *returns*

Every Talent Connect room carries a clear conversion strategy, designed backwards from the decisions it needs to produce. It is how leaders know their day will be worth it.

01 Who is invited, and why

02 What the leaders will see

03 How interest becomes a decision

04 How every person stays in the ecosystem afterwards

FOR HIRING DECISIONS

Direct hiring · Decision conviction · Culture fit, observed

FOR INTEGRITY AND TRUST

Authentic, human evaluation · Direct line of sight

Talent Connect room

FOR THE EMPLOYER BRAND

Brand experienced first-hand · Visibility · Employer of first choice

FOR LEADERS AND THE BUSINESS

Leadership access · Visibility into what is built · Talent intelligence

FOR THE COMMUNITY

Peer connection · Learning from practitioners · Mentoring · Recognition · Career clarity · A first look at opportunities · Referrals · A warmer ecosystem

TAKEAWAY

A room without a conversion strategy is an event. A room with one is a decision forum, and every result it creates, hired or not, stays with the organisation.

14 · ONE NEED, START TO FINISH

A capability, from plan to *decision*

An illustration of how the model runs, not a case study.



AN ILLUSTRATION, NOT A CASE STUDY

The plan. An organisation's plan for the coming year includes a new platform engineering capability. Under the traditional model, the first requisition would be raised when the budget is approved, and the search would begin from zero.

Attract. Instead, the TA team sits with the business when the plan is being shaped. Together they define the capability in working terms — the problems the team will solve, not a list of keywords — and map where those engineers work, write and gather. Invitations go out to professionals who would never have applied: a conversation with the organisation's architects, a look at the real platform, a place among peers. Each person who joins passes the entry checks and the three gates.

Engage. Over the following weeks, the cadence runs. A practitioner session on the organisation's architecture. A leader's short video on why the platform matters. A peer roundtable. A monthly Build Day on a real problem from the platform roadmap. The TA team watches who contributes, who refers others and who asks about the work.

Convert. When the budget is approved, the organisation does not start a search; it starts a conversation. A Talent Connect room is planned with a clear conversion strategy: who is invited, what the leaders want to see, and how decisions will be closed. On the day, working groups take on a live platform problem; leaders hold one-to-one conversations; the decision forum meets while everything is fresh; the bridge closes decisions into offers.

After the room. Some professionals join. Others are not right for this role, or not ready to move, and they stay in the ecosystem, still engaged, still warmer. When the next platform role opens, the organisation already knows who to call.

What the business noticed. Leaders met talent directly instead of last. The employer brand was experienced, not advertised. And the capability was ready closer to when the plan needed it.

TAKEAWAY

In the new model, approving the budget is not the start of a search. It is the start of a decision, with people the organisation already knows.

15 · WHO DOES WHAT

Three parties, *one ecosystem*

An operating model works when everyone knows their part. This one shares the work the way a well-designed system shares responsibility.

THE ORGANISATION

Owens the decisions and the ecosystem

- The business plan and the capabilities it needs
- Leaders' and practitioners' time
- Every hiring decision and offer, and the screening, interviewing, onboarding and induction it runs
- The ecosystem itself: it stays with the organisation

WEITA, WITH THE TA TEAM

Designs and runs the operating model

- Mapping capability and curating entry
- Designing and running the engagement calendar
- Designing each room and its conversion strategy, and facilitating the day
- Bringing back talent intelligence, and keeping the ecosystem warm

THE PROFESSIONALS

Bring themselves and their work

- Contribute to sessions and real problems
- Refer people they trust
- Decide whether and when to move

THE STANDING, EVERGREEN TALENT ECOSYSTEM

The TA team leads the relationship with the market. It works with the business on what is coming, represents the employer in the ecosystem, and owns how engagement turns into decisions. WeiTA works alongside it.

TAKEAWAY

The organisation decides and keeps the ecosystem. WeiTA builds and runs the model with the TA team. The professionals choose.

16 · WHAT CHANGES, WHAT STAYS

Same titles, better use of *time*

Titles stay the same. What changes is how time is spent.

Every requisition-led process creates **operational load**: repeated tasks (posting, sorting, scheduling, chasing, counting) that consume time without adding lasting value to the business.

Title	Operational load today	New model
Recruiter	Managing listings across multiple job portals; screening high volumes of unqualified and AI-generated applications; verifying whether applications are authentic; long scheduling chains; repeated follow-ups and candidate drop-off	The organisation's face to the talent market: represents the employer, engages the right professionals, and brings back market intelligence
TA Team Lead	Tracking CV counts, turnaround times and requisition volume; monitoring pipeline stages; resolving pipeline gaps role by role	Works with the business on upcoming needs, keeps the right professionals engaged for each skill area, and fills immediate needs quickly from people already known
TA Manager	Managing agencies and portals; reporting time-to-fill, submittal ratios and offer acceptance	Plans working sessions with business leaders on real problems, and owns how engagement turns into hiring decisions

Screening, interviewing, onboarding and induction stay in place. The new model reduces the operational load around them, so each role spends more of its time on what moves the business.

TAKEAWAY

The same people, with the same titles, spend less time moving paperwork and more time moving the business.

17 · SIX AVATARS

Six roles, *one model*

A new operating model changes how six roles experience hiring. Find yours.



CEO

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

A business plan that moves faster than hiring can

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
Talent ready when the plan moves



CFO

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

Talent spend spread across vacancies, agencies and portals

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
Talent investment in an ecosystem the organisation keeps



CHRO

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

Being held to time-to-fill instead of workforce outcomes

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
A seat in shaping the workforce strategy with the board



TA Leader

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

Being pulled into requisition operations

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
The role of front door to the talent market



Hiring Manager

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

Time lost in repeated interview rounds

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
Decisions made on real work



Recruiter

THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS

Time lost to portals, volume and chasing

THE NEW MODEL GIVES
The role of the organisation's face to the talent market

TAKEAWAY

The same six people, asked for different things: less carrying, more deciding.

18 · TA LEADERS AT THE FOREFRONT

TA leaders, at the start of *the plan*

For a long time, talent acquisition has been asked to be fast and inexpensive. The new model asks it to be something more valuable: the organisation's front door to the talent market.

In practice, that means three things.

At the planning table. A TA leader who runs a standing ecosystem can tell the business what is possible before the plan is fixed: which capabilities are reachable, how warm the market is, where the organisation is known and where it is not. That makes talent part of the plan, not a constraint discovered after it.

Holding the organisation's relationship with the market. The ecosystem is the organisation's, and the TA leader is its custodian: who is in it, how it is engaged, how it converts, and how it stays warm through freezes as well as growth. When roles are frozen, the ecosystem keeps working — learning, contributing, staying close — so nothing built is lost.

Bringing intelligence back. Every session, room and conversation tells the organisation something: what professionals expect, which skills are moving, how the employer brand is actually experienced. The TA leader turns that into workforce insight for the CHRO and the business.

None of this removes the work talent teams already do well. It changes where their time goes, and how the business sees their contribution: from filling requisitions to readying the organisation for its plan.

“In this new landscape, where automation accelerates the routine, HR becomes the strategist shaping what humans can achieve alongside it.”

Vidya Munirathnam, VP – HR, Lowe's India (People Matters, December 2025)

TAKEAWAY

In the new model, the TA leader moves from the end of the plan to the start of it.

19 · MEASURES BEYOND TIME-TO-FILL

Measure what the ecosystem *returns*

Time-to-fill tells an organisation how long a seat was empty. A standing ecosystem needs measures that show whether the business was ready, whether the decision was right, and what was built for next time.

READINESS

Is talent ready when the plan moves?

- Time from approved need to decision
- Roles filled from the ecosystem
- Engaged professionals per critical capability

DECISION QUALITY

Was it the right decision?

- Quality of hire at 6 and 12 months
- Hiring-manager confidence
- Offer-to-join rate, read as funnel decay

EFFICIENCY

What did it cost the business?

- Leader and panel hours per decision
- External spend per role, over the year

BRAND AND TRUST

Is the organisation experienced, and chosen?

- Would professionals recommend it after an engagement?
- Referrals from inside the ecosystem

INTELLIGENCE

What did the market tell us?

- Insights returned to the business each quarter

Suggestions to adapt rather than benchmarks: choose a few that matter most to the plan, and track them over a year, because an ecosystem compounds.

TAKEAWAY

Measure readiness, decision quality and what was built, as well as how long a seat stayed empty.

20 · SELF-ASSESSMENT

Where does your talent acquisition stand?

Score each statement: **0** not yet · **1** partly · **2** consistently.

Statement	0	1	2
01 Talent acquisition is involved when the business plan is being set, not after a role is approved.	☐	☐	☐
02 We know where the professionals for our critical capabilities work today, by name, not just by job board.	☐	☐	☐
03 We have an engaged community of professionals for at least one critical capability, before roles open.	☐	☐	☐
04 Professionals experience our organisation directly — our leaders and our real work — before they are asked to apply.	☐	☐	☐
05 Our engagement with the market runs on a steady cadence, not only through one-off events or drives.	☐	☐	☐
06 Our leaders meet professionals early in the process, not only in the final round.	☐	☐	☐
07 Our evaluation includes real work done live, not only résumés, assessments and serial interviews.	☐	☐	☐
08 We stay in active contact with every professional between stages and through to joining.	☐	☐	☐
09 People we did not hire stay engaged with us for future roles.	☐	☐	☐
10 We measure talent acquisition by readiness and decision quality, not only by time-to-fill and cost per hire.	☐	☐	☐

YOUR SCORE

0–7 · Requisition-led. Hiring reacts to needs. Begin with one capability and one quarter (page 21).

8–14 · In transition. Parts of an ecosystem exist. Connect them with a cadence and a conversion strategy.

15–20 · Ecosystem-led. Talent is ready when the plan moves. Extend the model to more capabilities, and share what you measure with the board.

21 · WHERE TO BEGIN

One capability, one *quarter*

The model does not need to be adopted everywhere at once. The clearest way to begin is with one capability the business will need, over one quarter.

Choose the capability. Pick one that is critical to the plan, hard to find, and likely to be needed more than once: an AI platform team, a product function, a specialist engineering group. Agree it with the business leader who will own the decisions.

Month 1 · Attract

Define the capability in working terms with the business. Map where those professionals work and gather. Agree how people will be checked on entry, then begin inviting them in.

Month 2 · Engage

Run the cadence: the weekly rhythm, the two tracks and one flagship — a Build Day on a real problem. Line up the practitioners who will lead the sessions. Watch who contributes, who refers, who asks about the work.

Month 3 · Convert

Design a Talent Connect room with a clear conversion strategy. Hold the day. Meet as a decision forum while everything is fresh, and close decisions through a short bridge. Keep everyone else in the ecosystem.

At the end of the quarter, review it with the business against the measures on page 19: what was decided, what was learned, how the organisation was experienced, and what the ecosystem now holds for the next role.

Before you start, agree three things: the business leader who owns the decisions; the practitioners who will give time to the cadence; and how the ecosystem will be kept warm after the quarter ends.

TAKEAWAY

One capability, one quarter, one room: enough to see the model work, and to build the first part of an ecosystem the organisation keeps.

WEITA IN THREE SENTENCES

WeiTA is a strategic talent acquisition partner bringing a new, business-led talent acquisition operating model to organisations, and helping them adopt it. The model moves hiring from transactional, requisition-based activity to a standing, evergreen talent ecosystem, through an approach WeiTA calls Attract, Engage and Convert. The process is re-architected around the business; the people – your TA team and partners – stay at the centre.

Putting the human back in HR.

We are Human in TA.



Talent Decisions Driven By
Conversation

GLOSSARY

Operating model — how talent acquisition is organised to work: who does what, when, and toward which results.

Requisition-led hiring — hiring that begins when a role is approved and ends when it is filled.

Standing, evergreen talent ecosystem — the organisation's own community of the professionals it will need, built before roles open and kept warm between them.

Attract — curated entry into the ecosystem, and its growth.

Engage — the engagement cadence that keeps relationships live.

Convert — the conversion architecture that turns relationships into decisions.

Talent Connect room — a one-day decision forum inside Convert, where curated professionals and decision-makers work on a real problem together.

Conversion strategy — the plan behind each room: who is invited, what leaders will see, how interest becomes a decision, and how everyone stays in the ecosystem.

Requisition relay — the chain of handoffs from business need to shortlist, where meaning is lost at each step.

Funnel decay — interest fading between stages, so professionals drop out at each step and between offer and joining.

AI doom loop — AI-shaped applications screened by AI, so neither side sees the real person.

Operational load — repeated tasks (posting, sorting, scheduling, chasing, counting) that consume time without adding lasting value to the business.

SOURCES AND METHOD

This methodology combines WeiTA's field observation through 2025–2026 (client conversations, summit floors and working sessions, anonymised and reported without attribution) with desk research. Every published figure and quote was checked at its source; figures that appeared only on vendor pages without a named original study were excluded. Where no verified figure exists, the pattern is described without a number.

- Zinnov–nasscom, India GCC Landscape 2026 (FY2026).
- PwC India and FICCI, study of 200 senior GCC executives, reported by ANI, 15 August 2026.
- HirePro, FY26 assessment integrity report, October 2026.
- The Conference Board, employer branding ROI, 2 April 2025 (US organisations).
- People Matters: Dr C. Jayakumar, Larsen & Toubro, 17 August 2026; Vidya Munirathnam, Lowe's India, 12 December 2025; Devashish Sharma, Taggd, September 2025.